



Source and provide destination information and advice

D2.TTA.CL2.19

Assessor Manual



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Assessor Manual

Project Base

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: SOURCE AND PROVIDE DESTINATION INFORMATION AND ADVICE		NOMINAL HOURS: 50
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTA.CL2.19		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to obtain and make available current destination information to colleagues and clients.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA	UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE	
Element 1: Generate initial destination knowledge 1.1 Identify <i>sources</i> of destination information 1.2 Describe <i>criteria for capturing destination information</i> 1.3 Identify <i>client needs relating to destination information</i> that may be required 1.4 Research destination information 1.5 Capture and <i>record and classify</i> destination and <i>general product information</i> Element 2: Update destination knowledge 2.1 Register to receive <i>updated destination information</i> 2.2 Integrate <i>updated information</i> into existing destination information 2.3 Initiate <i>new files</i> for new information and/or	Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to the obtaining current destination information and making it available to colleagues and clients, within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Front Office 2. Housekeeping 3. Food and Beverage Service 4. Food Production 5. Travel Agencies 6. Tour Operation Sources may relate to: • Internal business sources, including databases, brochures, destination and product libraries and books	

new destinations Element 3: Communicate destination knowledge 3.1 Identify <i>client and colleague needs</i> relating to destination information that is required 3.2 <i>Share destination information</i> 3.3 <i>Advise clients</i> in relation to information about specific destinations 3.4 Present hard copy information to clients Element 4: Review provision of destination knowledge 4.1 <i>Evaluate sources of destination information</i> 4.2 <i>Evaluate methods of provision of destination information</i> 4.3 <i>Evaluate effectiveness of destination information provision</i> 4.4 <i>Amend or confirm sources of destination information</i>	• Direct contact with: ▪ Travel suppliers including airlines, cruise operators, railway operators, bus lines, car rental businesses, limousine hire, taxis ▪ Suppliers and providers of support and ancillary services, including accommodation, conference and similar venues ▪ Tour operators and wholesalers ▪ Travel agencies and associations ▪ Peak travel bodies ▪ Government tourism industry bodies and authorities, including domestic and international bodies • Literature, including reference maps, city guides, books, magazines and newspapers • Websites, including individual companies, directories, news sites, surveys and research sites • Personal network of contacts, including those within the host enterprise and those external to the business. Criteria for capturing destination information must include: • Accuracy • Currency • Completeness • Reliability and reputation of source • Cost • Ease-of-access • Copyright-free status of information.
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	<i>Client needs relating to destination information</i> will vary depending on the products and services provided by the host enterprise and may include: • Major tourist attractions, including natural and man-made • Directions on moving around the destination, including maps and directories • Major tourist areas within destinations, including designation and location of various unique precincts • Geographical features, including near-by regional features • Famous buildings and landmarks, including near-by regional features • Festivals and religious occasions • Local economy, including state of the economy, financial institutions, access to funds, currency used and exchange rates • Local customs, including observances, religious requirements, actions that may give unintentional offence, needs for local specific sensitivity and special features of the destination community/ies • Legislation and regulations, including offences and personal responsibilities across a wide range of topics with special reference to specific prohibitions that may not exist in client home country or the country of departure • Local facilities, including public and fee-for service • Health, safety and security considerations • Government warnings, travel advisories and updates • Specific sporting, shopping, cultural, religious and other facilities and services • Degree and sophistication of basic infrastructure, including roads, power and utilities • Climate and seasonal weather conditions • Ability of destination to cater for clients with special needs, including age-related needs, language, and disabilities
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	• Food and beverages, including identification of local dishes and drinks • Range of choice and availability of products and services, for all facilities, retail purchases, accommodation, basic needs, transport and specific client needs • Passport and visa requirements • Customs and taxes. <i>Research</i> refers to formal and informal research techniques and may include: • Informal discussions with colleagues and clients • Formal study, including study undertaken on-the-job provided by employers or vocational training undertaken in personal time and at personal expense • Reading literature, including brochures, magazines, media articles, trade journals, guide books and destination material • Attending relevant information sessions and events, including product launches, updates, seminars, trade conferences and exhibitions • Visiting destinations, venues, attractions and sites, including familiarisations • Direct contact with organisations from the targeted destination • Accessing the internet and targeted destination websites • Watching videos, television and films. <i>Record and classify</i> information may include the use of: • Card reference systems • Files and notes of destinations • Files and notes for touring routes and locations • Files and notes for target market groups • Computerised databases – including division of data into folders, sub-folders and files
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	• Index to assist in identifying required information • Compliance with internal guidelines and authorities regarding the entering of data onto systems. <i>General product information</i> may be found, in addition to the above sources, in the following: • Industry, establishment and destination brochures – including those produced by private companies and public tourist agencies and authorities • Sales and supplier information kits provided by destination providers – including accommodation outlets, providers and support businesses, shopping centres and precincts, attractions and event organisers • Product manuals • Advertising fliers. General product information may include: • Styles of product and services available within destinations • Seasonal availability of product, including low and high seasons, and weather-related seasonal influences • Geographic location of products and services at the destinations. Register to receive updated destination information may include: • Registering on-line • Paying a fee • Establishing required password and username, if required • Lodging host enterprise details with information source • Establishing the <i>bona fides</i> of the host enterprise • Joining an association or body in order to enable access.
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	<i>Integrate updated information</i> may include: • Deleting dated information • Deleting information files and folders no longer required • Implementing version control procedures • Up-dating relevant control index to reflect revised information files and folders • Adding data to identify date of last update. <i>Initiate new files</i> may include: • Up-dating relevant control index to reflect new information files and folders • Informing colleagues of the presence of new information. <i>Client and colleague needs</i> may include: • Reference to specific requests or questions that have been made • Specific data sharing with sales staff and specialist destination colleagues • Providing detailed information to new employees • Specific requirements relating to target client groups with which nominated colleagues are engaged. Share destination information may include: • Advising verbally, including face-to-face and over the telephone • Providing hard copy information, including internal distribution and mailing/couriering to agencies and sub-agencies • Forwarding files electronically. Advise clients may include: • Advising verbally, including face-to-face and over the telephone
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	• Providing hard copy information, including face-to-face handouts and mailing/couriering to client address • Forwarding files electronically • Arranging a meeting with the client • Conducting in-house destination information evenings/sessions for targeted groups • Delivering advice personally in client office or home • Promoting destinations to groups as part of the selling process, including the delivery of a presentation • Providing advice and suggestions factoring in identified requirements and constraints, including budget, duration, timing and personal preferences • Preparing draft itineraries and quotations • Offering alternatives • Making recommendations based on personal knowledge and experience. Evaluate sources of destination information may include: • Seeking feedback from colleagues • Seeking feedback from clients on their return from destinations • Comparing information from different sources regarding the same destination • Relating destination information to personal experience and knowledge • Undertaking a cost-benefit analysis, where applicable • Assessing source against criteria for capturing destination information. Evaluate methods of provision may include: • Seeking feedback from clients on the utility of current methods • Appraising new options
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	• Assessing methods used by the competition • Revising current information provision methods on the basis of feedback and emerging options. Evaluate effectiveness of destination information may include: • Seeking feedback from clients on satisfaction with information provided, including scope and content • Identifying deficiencies in information provided • Creating new areas for information provision. <i>Amend or confirm sources</i> may include: • Checking and verifying information provided by sources being used • Researching new sources • Determining sources used by other businesses for provision of destination information. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Enterprise policies and procedures in regard to sourcing, accessing and using destination information • Principles relating to copyright and intellectual property issues • Ability to use standard research techniques • Communication, interpersonal and information-sharing skills • Basic keyboarding and data entry skills • Industry knowledge relating to basic destination information • Market research data regarding the target market segments for the host enterprise.
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Linkages To Other Units

- Operate an automated information system
- Source and package tourism products and services
- Promote tourism products and services
- Prepare and submit quotations
- Access and retrieve computer-based data
- Communicate on the telephone
- Receive and process reservations
- Book and co-ordinate supplier services
- Construct and ticket a non-air travel plan
- Construct and ticket domestic airfares
- Construct and ticket promotional international airfares
- Construct and ticket regular international airfares
- Access and interpret product information
- Prepare and deliver a presentation.

Critical Aspects of Assessment

Evidence of the following is essential:

- Understanding of arrangements that exist to determine and authenticate sources of information that are to be used
- Demonstrated ability to research, obtain and provide hard copy current destination information for a nominated range of domestic and international destinations to meet given end-user needs

	• Demonstrated ability to capture and electronically record destination information for a nominated range of domestic and international destinations to meet given end-user needs • Demonstrated ability to update nominated destination information categories/classifications for a given list of domestic and international destinations • Demonstrated ability to provide verbal advice, including options and recommendations, to a client in relation to a single nominated destination across a range of identified destination information categories/classifications • Demonstrated ability to obtain verbal or written feedback from a client in relation to the form and content of previously provided destination information. Context of Assessment Assessment must ensure: • Actual or simulated workplace application of strategies, techniques and procedures for researching, obtaining, recording and supplying destination information. Resource Implications Training and assessment must include use of actual systems, databases, materials, information sources and actual or simulated clients in an actual or simulated office environment; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Observation of practical candidate performance • Simulated exercises • Portfolio of documentation and information obtained in the course of research, sourcing and information gathering, recording and updating activities • Role plays • Oral and written questions
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	• Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work. Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Source, evaluate, capture information on destinations from a variety of sources on a variety of topics
	Communicating ideas and information	1	Request destination information from sources; advise clients in relation to destination information obtained
	Planning and organising activities	1	Determine sources of destination information to research and schedule those research activities to integrate with other work activities
	Working with others and in teams	1	Share destination information with colleagues/clients
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Cost elements of captured information; determine travel times and distances
	Solving problems	1	Identify and access alternative and/or additional sources of destination information where necessary; resolve itinerary conflicts

	Using technology	1	Use internet/computerised systems to research, access, capture, record, transmit destination information
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Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Source and provide destination information and advice D2.TTA.CL2.19
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Why are the use of 'personal observations' an effective source of destination information?	☐	☐
2. Why is a 'criterion'? Why is it important to have criteria when collecting destination information?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Why is it important to understand both colleague and client needs when collecting destination information?	☐	☐
4. What are three examples of colleague needs when collecting destination information?	☐	☐
5. How can you receive destination information from external sources?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What are considerations when capturing and storing destination information into organisational files?	☐	☐
7. Why do businesses register for destination information?	☐	☐
8. Why is not all destination information captured integrated into organisational storage systems?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. What is the difference between manual and electronic information storage systems? What are the benefits of both?	☐	☐
10. What are considerations when sharing updated information with potential customers?	☐	☐
11. If you were a customer seeking a holiday in another country, what destination information would you like to know?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. What are examples of 'non-air' documentation that may be given to clients?	☐	☐
13. Why is it important to evaluate sources of destination information?	☐	☐
14. Why would you evaluate the methods you use to provide information to clients?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. How can you measure the effectiveness of information provided to clients?	☐	☐
16. Why is it vital to monitor and manage destination information inventory?	☐	☐

Written questions

Source and provide destination information and advice – D2.TTA.CL2.19

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What are three types of travel and tourism businesses that provide destination information?

2. What are two formats in which destination information can be provided?

3. What are two examples of criteria used when capturing destination information?

4. What are methods / techniques used to ensure compliance with information collection criteria?

5. What are examples of organisational needs that must be considered when collecting destination information?

6. What are types of clients who seek destination information?

7. Select one of the types of clients that you identified in Question 6, and describe the needs they may have when arranging travel?

8. What types of destination information do you want to gather for a client?

9. What are two steps undertaken when researching destination information?

10. What are two types of formal and informal research techniques used to collect destination information?

11. What are three types of internal destination information sources?

12. What are three benefits of visiting external sources of destination information?

13. What are ways to register for destination information?

14. What are examples of manual filing systems used for storing destination information?

15. What are two examples of Global Distribution Systems?

16. What are examples of tasks associated with integrating information into existing destination information?

17. How can you 'identify or mark' information found for later use?

18. How can you share updated destination information with colleagues?

19. What are the three methods used to submit destination information to a client?

20. What are customer service basics when presenting destination information to clients?

21. What types of destination information may be provided to customers?

22. What are the benefits of providing hard copy materials to clients?

23. What are three types of hard copy destination information that can be given to clients?

24. Why is it important to evaluate sources of destination information?

25. What are strategies used for evaluating sources of information?

26. How can you ensure you have accurate and updated destination information?

27. What are methods used to evaluate methods and effectiveness of provision of information to clients?

28. How often would you review how destination information is provided to customers? Provide reasoning for your answer.

29. At times you will be required to select new suppliers of destination information. What steps are associated with this process?

30. What are reasons for the need to update destination information inventory?

Answers to written questions

Source and provide destination information and advice – D2.TTA.CL2.19

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. **What are three types of travel and tourism businesses that provide destination information?**
 - Airlines
 - Other travel suppliers
 - Suppliers and providers of support and ancillary services
 - Accommodation
 - Attractions and Theme Parks
 - Tour Operators
 - Inbound Tour Wholesaler
 - Outbound Tour Wholesaler
 - Retail Travel Agents
 - Local, regional and national information services
 - Meetings and Events
 - Ministries of Tourism
 - Tourism Boards
 - Industry Authorities
 - Industry Associations.
2. **What are two formats in which destination information can be provided?**
 - Brochures/DVDs
 - Hotel and accommodation guides and indexes
 - Atlases, maps and encyclopaedias
 - Travel guides
 - Individual timetables
 - Automated information systems
 - Computerised Reservations Systems (CRS)
 - International airline guides
 - Travel Trade Yearbook
 - Travel Information Manual (TIM)
 - Passenger air tariff
 - Trade press

- General print and electronic media, travel magazines and even news bulletins for current issues
- Educationals
- Product familiarisations
- Other organisations in the industry
- The internet, travel websites, travel advisor, blogs
- Travel companies product launches, travel shows and information nights
- Government agencies
- Intranet Websites
- Internal information databases
- Product manuals
- Supplier information and sales kits and their sales representatives
- Destination and product experts
- Confidential and general industry tariffs
- Preferred contracts and/or agreements
- Official country tourist offices, authorities and bureaus
- Your own travel experience
- Colleagues.

3. **What are two examples of criteria used when capturing destination information?**

- Accuracy
- Currency
- Completeness
- Reliability and reputation of source
- Cost
- Ease-of-access
- Copyright-free status of information.

4. **What are methods / techniques used to ensure compliance with information collection criteria?**

- Use of checklists
- Putting yourself in the eyes of the customer
- Checking to ensure you have all necessary information
- Identify date in which current information was compiled
- Checking version of the brochure or information
- Checking on the website for accurate 'real time' information
- Contacting the supplier to verify information.

5. **What are examples of organisational needs that must be considered when collecting destination information?**
- Business objectives
 - Key market segments or clients
 - Types and style of tourism activities and destinations current offered
 - Types of destinations or services that could be combined with current activities and services
 - How the information provided could be used to improve service
 - Enhancing and expanding destination range
 - Movement into new target markets
 - Reputation and image
 - Business agreements, including franchise and other contractual arrangements
 - Meeting competition
 - Involvement of colleagues in determining requirements
 - Potential increase in business and profitability.
6. **What are types of clients who seek destination information?**
- Domestic and international people
 - Males and females
 - People from different age groups
 - Special interest groups
 - Special needs clients
 - Open groups
 - Homogenous target market groups as defined by various demographic characteristics.
7. **Select one of the types of clients that you identified in Question 6, and describe the needs they may have when arranging travel?**
- Answers will vary.

8. **What types of destination information do you want to gather for a client?**
 - Destination information
 - Local community information
 - International destination information
 - Tours
 - Attractions
 - Activities
 - History
 - Geographical features
 - Local customs and culture
 - Climate
 - Accommodation
 - Amenities and services
 - Airlines
 - Car hire
 - Cruises
 - Transfers
 - Rail.
9. **What are two steps undertaken when researching destination information?**
 - Identify the research points
 - Identify types of formal and informal research techniques
 - Recollection of personal observations
 - Accessing internal information
 - Accessing external sources of information
 - Visits sources of information
 - Establishing industry networks.
10. **What are two types of formal and informal research techniques used to collect destination information?**
 - Informal discussions with colleagues and clients
 - Formal study
 - Reading literature
 - Attending relevant information sessions and events
 - Visiting destinations
 - Direct contact with organisations
 - Accessing the internet and targeted destination websites
 - Watching videos, television and films.

11. **What are three types of internal destination information sources?**
 - Destination information previously collected
 - Customer feedback information
 - Automated information systems
 - Computerised reservation systems
 - Destinations and services inventories.
12. **What are three benefits of visiting external sources of destination information?**
 - Meet key personnel
 - Talking with personnel to obtain, clarify, update and identify supplementary relevant information
 - Gain an understanding of the operation
 - Viewing operations and making personal observations
 - Clarify and explain your request for information
 - Receive electronic and hard copy files in a user friendly manner
 - Reviewing additional information available at the source
 - Get any questions answered
 - Identify the potential of informational sources that can be utilised at a later date
 - Recording interviews and taking photographs or other recorded images.
13. **What are ways to register for destination information?**
 - Registering on-line
 - Paying a fee
 - Establishing required password and username, if required
 - Lodging host enterprise details with product information source
 - Establishing the bona fides of the host enterprise
 - Joining an association or body in order to enable access.
14. **What are examples of manual filing systems used for storing destination information?**
 - Card reference systems
 - Files
 - Public area displays
 - Back of house storage areas
 - Filing cabinets
 - Personal information manual
 - Contact details of tourism businesses.

15. **What are two examples of Global Distribution Systems?**
 - Travelport (Galileo, & Apollo)
 - Travelport (Worldspan)
 - Amadeus
 - Sabre.
16. **What are examples of tasks associated with integrating information into existing destination information?**
 - Deleting dated information
 - Deleting information files and folders no longer required
 - Implementing version control procedures
 - Up-dating relevant control index to reflect revised information files and folders
 - Adding data to identify date of last update
 - Up-dating relevant control index to reflect new information files and folders
 - Informing colleagues of the presence of new information.
17. **How can you 'identify or mark' information found for later use?**
 - Book marking websites
 - Recording sources in a project-specific index.
 - Copy and pasting key points into separate files
 - Highlighting key information
 - Filing documents in a logical order.
18. **How can you share updated destination information with colleagues?**
 - On a one to one basis
 - At staff briefings
 - At staff meetings
 - E-mail co-workers
 - Update the internal systems
 - Replace and replenish internal displays information points
 - Arrange for a guest speaker
 - Arrange for staff to visit the venue.
19. **What are the three methods used to submit destination information to a client?**
 - Verbal explanation
 - Provide hard copy materials
 - Provide electronic materials.

20. What are customer service basics when presenting destination information to clients?

- Have comprehensive product knowledge
- Remember to consider customer needs, wants and preferences
- Ask questions
- Be proactive
- Provide information, recommendations, advice and suggestions that aligns with identified customer need
- Sell the benefits of products and services
- Overcome objections by customers to making a purchase
- Allow customers time and opportunity to consider their purchase
- Make legitimate all add-on/complementary sales
- Close the sale.

21. What types of destination information may be provided to customers?

General information:

- Date of quotation and reference number (if applicable)
- Clients name
- Phone contacts
- Email address
- Address
- Dates of travel
- Length of travel and class of travel.

Travel products and services:

- Flights
- Accommodation
- Cruises
- Tours
- Other travel products and services
- Transfers
- Car hire/Rentals.

Destination information:

- Attractions
- Activities
- History
- Language
- Population

- Geographical features
- Local customs and culture
- Climate.

Specialist destination information:

- Seasonality
- Availability
- Costing considerations
- Additional travel costs
- Product price increases
- Fluctuations in exchange rates
- Terms and conditions
- Travel insurance
- Visa / permits
- Health permits
- Limitations
- Safety and risk – adventure products
- Non operation of the product – tour cancellation.

22. What are the benefits of providing hard copy materials to clients?

- Utilises an additional learning method - as opposed to listening to a presentation
- Provides comprehensive information
- Provides appealing images
- Provides information in its intended message
- Enables the audience to review information at their own time and at their own pace
- Enables information to be reviewed on multiple purposes
- Enables the audience to show other people information as well
- Enables audience to become familiar with content before subsequent verbal presentations and meetings.

23. What are three types of hard copy destination information that can be given to clients?

- Reports
- Proposals
- Brochures
- Quotations
- Invitations
- Travel itineraries
- Handouts

- Fact sheets
- Notes
- Photocopies from policy manuals
- Texts
- Media articles
- Photographs
- Posters
- Flyers
- Marketing materials.

24. **Why is it important to evaluate sources of destination information?**

- Promote legitimate destinations, suppliers, products and services
- Ensure the information provided is a true reflection of what is being promoted
- Ensure customers don't receive materials no longer available
- Materials show current prices
- Help you refer only to current information
- Demonstrates professionalism and attention to detail.

25. **What are strategies used for evaluating sources of information?**

- Seeking feedback from colleagues
- Seeking feedback from clients on their return from destinations
- Comparing information from different sources regarding the same destination
- Relating destination information to personal experience and knowledge
- Assessing source against criteria for capturing destination information
- Researching comments on websites.

26. **How can you ensure you have accurate and updated destination information?**

- Observing expiry dates of information
- Looking up updates
- Read briefings of new information
- Monitoring relevant industry trends and issues
- Participating in local familiarisation tours
- Observing media
- Getting on mailing lists.

27. What are methods used to evaluate methods and effectiveness of provision of information to clients?

- Seeking feedback from clients
- Identifying which methods are preferred by existing clients
- Identifying deficiencies in information provided
- Appraising new options
- Creating new areas for information provision
- Assessing methods used by the competition
- Revising current information provision methods on the basis of feedback and emerging options.

28. How often would you review how destination information is provided to customers? Provide reasoning for your answer.

Answers will vary.

29. At times you will be required to select new suppliers of destination information. What steps are associated with this process?

- Identifying suitable sources and suppliers of destination information
- Identifying client requirements in terms of destination information
- Collecting information as to whom provides information relating to these products and services
- Identifying suitable suppliers or sources
- Assessing alternatives against the identified client requirements
- Accommodating host enterprise requirements in relation to the use of preferred suppliers, providers and carriers
- Aligning with established client preferences
- Confirm sources / suppliers of destination information.

30. What are reasons for the need to update destination information inventory.

Answers are endless however include:

- Price changes
- Changes to products and services
- New packages
- Updated facilities
- New attractions
- Changes in visa requirements
- New management
- New awards or stories of interest.

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Source and provide destination information and advice D2.TTA.CL2.19
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Generate initial destination knowledge - Update destination knowledge - Communicate destination knowledge - Review provision of destination knowledge - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Generate initial destination knowledge		
Identify sources of destination information	☐	☐
Describe criteria for capturing destination information	☐	☐
Identify client needs relating to destination information that may be required	☐	☐
Research destination information	☐	☐
Capture and record and classify destination and general product information	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Update destination knowledge		
Register to receive updated destination information	☐	☐
Integrate updated information into existing destination information	☐	☐
Initiate new files for new information and/or new destinations	☐	☐
Element 3: Communicate destination knowledge		
Identify client and colleague needs relating to destination information that is required	☐	☐
Share destination information	☐	☐
Advise clients in relation to information about specific destinations	☐	☐
Present hard copy information to clients	☐	☐
Element 4: Review provision of destination knowledge		
Evaluate sources of destination information	☐	☐
Evaluate methods of provision of destination information	☐	☐
Evaluate effectiveness of destination information provision	☐	☐
Amend or confirm sources of destination information	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest		
Unit of competency:	Source and provide destination information and advice D2.TTA.CL2.19		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Generate initial destination knowledge			
Identify sources of destination information	☐	☐	☐
Describe criteria for capturing destination information	☐	☐	☐
Identify client needs relating to destination information that may be required	☐	☐	☐
Research destination information	☐	☐	☐
Capture and record and classify destination and general product information	☐	☐	☐
Element 2: Update destination knowledge			
Register to receive updated destination information	☐	☐	☐
Integrate updated information into existing destination information	☐	☐	☐
Initiate new files for new information and/or new destinations	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 3: Communicate destination knowledge			
Identify client and colleague needs relating to destination information that is required	☐	☐	☐
Share destination information	☐	☐	☐
Advise clients in relation to information about specific destinations	☐	☐	☐
Present hard copy information to clients	☐	☐	☐
Element 4: Review provision of destination knowledge			
Evaluate sources of destination information	☐	☐	☐
Evaluate methods of provision of destination information	☐	☐	☐
Evaluate effectiveness of destination information provision	☐	☐	☐
Amend or confirm sources of destination information	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**Third party signature:****Date:****Send to:**

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Source and provide destination information and advice	D2.TTA.CL2.19
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Generate initial destination knowledge						
Identify sources of destination information						
Describe criteria for capturing destination information						
Identify client needs relating to destination information that may be required						
Research destination information						
Capture and record and classify destination and general product information						
Element 2: Update destination knowledge						
Register to receive updated destination information						
Integrate updated information into existing destination information						
Initiate new files for new information and/or new destinations						

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Communicate destination knowledge						
Identify client and colleague needs relating to destination information that is required						
Share destination information						
Advise clients in relation to information about specific destinations						
Present hard copy information to clients						
Element 4: Review provision of destination knowledge						
Evaluate sources of destination information						
Evaluate methods of provision of destination information						
Evaluate effectiveness of destination information provision						
Amend or confirm sources of destination information						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

